

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS



INDIA-RUSSIA -3

MODULE - 38

IRRITANTS IN THE RELATIONSHIP

India-Russia relationship is not free from problems and constraints. These issues can be categorized into

- Relations with United States
- China Factor
- Multilateral
- Economic
- Kudakulam Project



CAATSA

- 1 • The United States has brought about a new Act **CAATSA, Countering America's Adversaries Through Sanctions Act**. It is an American law that imposed sanctions on Iran, North Korea, and Russia, particularly with Russia's defense and intelligence sectors.
- 2 By this Act, the **US can punish Moscow's military partners** on the basis that their business dealings violate American law.
- 3 As the largest buyer of Russian weapons, **India is vulnerable to Section 231 of the new law, which imposes sanctions** on individuals and countries that deal with Russia's intelligence and defence sectors.
- 4 Significant weapons deal reflect the growing relationship between India and Russia and it will be difficult to abandon defence ties with Russia.
- 5 It resulted in Russia and Pakistan signed their first ever military cooperation agreement in November 2014 on the argument that if India buys from the US, Russia can sell to Pakistan.



MULTILATERAL PROJECTS

- 1 The foundation of the 'Quad' with India, USA, Japan and Australia also makes Russia skeptical. Russia is downgrading its military-technical relationship with India, from exclusive to preferred partner.
- 2 Western sanctions on Iran can majorly affect the development of Chabahar Port. This port is essential for International North South Trade Corridor.
- 3 Russia had proposed a Russia-India-China (RIC) forum. India is hesitant about this because of the unresolved issues with China.



CHINA FACTOR

- 1 China is Russia's biggest trading partner and the largest Asian investor in Russia
- 2 Russia is a natural strategic partner in China's OBOR initiative and its connectivity to Europe
- 3 It plans to link the Eurasian Economic Union (EAEU) to the BRI



ECONOMIC ISSUES

- 1 In spite of efforts from both countries, Indo-Russian trade has not reached great heights.
- 2 India is concerned about the bilateral trade deficit it suffers with Russia and wants the two sides to focus on ways to balance trade



KUDANKULAM PROJECT

- 1 The people of Kudankulam village argue that they were misled by false promises such as 10,000 jobs, water from Pechiparai dam in Kanyakumari district
- 2 They fear they may be displaced, and will have to deal with radioactive poison.
- 3 The villagers argue that reactors are being set up without sharing the Environmental Impact Assessment (EIA), Site Evaluation Study and Safety Analysis Report with the people
- 4 There is no democratic decision-making in or public approval for this project.
- 5 The important issue of liability for the Russian plants has not been addressed.



KUDANKULAM PROJECT

- 6 The Inter-Governmental Agreement (IGA) signed in 2008 by the Indian and Russian governments defies the Indian nuclear liability and Article 13 of the IGA establishes that NPCIL is solely responsible for all claims of damages
- 7 The coolant water and low-grade waste from the KKNPP are going to be dumped in to the sea which will have a severe impact on fish production and catch. It will undermine the fishing industry and affect the food security in Tamil Nadu and southern Kerala.
- 8 The project would be emitting Iodine 131, 132, 133, Cesium 134, 136, 137 isotopes, strontium, tritium, tellurium and other such radioactive particles into our air, land, crops, cattle, sea, seafood and ground water.
- 9 The southern coastal belt already affected by high incidence of cancer, mental retardation, down syndrome, defective births due to private and government sea-sand mining for rare minerals including thorium; will further suffer



The Strategic Economic Dialogue has emerged as a promising mechanism to promote mutually beneficial economic cooperation across sectors between India and Russia

FIRST INDIA-RUSSIA STRATEGIC ECONOMIC DIALOGUE

1 The first India-Russia Strategic Economic Dialogue (IRSED) was held at St Petersburg, Russia, from 25-26 November 2018.

2 It identified five core areas to improve bilateral trade, economic and investment cooperation—development of transport infrastructure and technologies; development of agriculture and agro-processing sector; small and medium business support; digital transformation and frontier technologies; and industrial cooperation and trade.

3 As an outcome of the Dialogue, an India-Russia Bilateral Council was set up in NITI Aayog to carry the objectives of the IRSED.



SECOND INDIA-RUSSIA STRATEGIC ECONOMIC DIALOGUE

- 1 The second Strategic Economic Dialogue between India and Russia was held in New Delhi in July 2019.
- 2 Future areas of cooperation across areas of transport infrastructure, agriculture, small and medium business support, digital transformation, trade, banking, investment, and tourism and connectivity were discussed
- 3 Government officials, business leaders and industry experts attended it



SECOND INDIA-RUSSIA STRATEGIC ECONOMIC DIALOGUE

AREAS OF COOPERATION

- 1 It focused on development of agriculture and agro-processing sectors with the use of technology and opportunities for cooperation in agriculture sector
- 2 The establishment of SME information portal to facilitate the dissemination of relevant information in the sector, identification of partners, access to credits, technologies and markets for SMEs were also discussed.
- 3 In tourism and connectivity, the two sides highlighted the policy and regulatory interventions required to boost regional connectivity and promote bilateral tourism.
- 4 Cooperation in the area of digital transformation and frontier technologies could include leveraging fintech solutions and exploring potential regional collaboration for smart cities and intelligent mobility between both the countries.



20TH INDIA – RUSSIA ANNUAL SUMMIT

"REACHING NEW HEIGHTS OF COOPERATION THROUGH TRUST AND PARTNERSHIP"

1 PM Modi visited Russia in September 2019 to attend the 20th India – Russia Annual Summit and participate in the 5th Eastern Economic Forum as the Chief Guest.

2 The leaders noted development of the Special and Privileged Strategic Partnership and appreciated the work of the India-Russia Intergovernmental Commission on Trade, Economic, Scientific, Technological and Cultural Cooperation which ensures progressive development of bilateral cooperation between India and Russia.



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3 Russia agreed to participate in major infrastructural and other projects in India through 'Make In India'.

4 India-Russia committed to upgrade their defence cooperation, industrial cooperation and create new technological and investment partnership

5 Roadmap for cooperation in Hydrocarbons for 2019 was signed and both Sides expected bilateral cooperation in this sector

6 The countries agreed to work on possibility of expanding direct passenger and cargo flights including flights between various regions of both the countries.



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7 Notwithstanding the constraints in the relationship, it needs to be noted that relations with Russia is an important pillar of India's foreign policy.

8 Russia has been a longstanding time-tested partner of India.

9 India and Russia will continue to remain a role model for harmonious and mutually beneficial partnership and strong friendship between States.

10 This will be the benefit to both the countries and international community as a whole.



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